

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 662

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Fisk University upon the celebration of its 160th anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those exemplary educational institutions that have made significant contributions, through an abiding commitment to excellence, to their respective communities and this State; and

WHEREAS, Fisk University, the oldest institution of higher learning in Nashville, is celebrating the 160th anniversary of its founding this year; and

WHEREAS, founded in 1866, the first class at Fisk University convened on January 9 of that year, with its first students ranging in age from seven to seventy and sharing common experiences of slavery and poverty; and

WHEREAS, in addition to the institution's reputation for academic excellence, Fisk University is home to the world-renowned Fisk Jubilee Singers, the student a cappella group that has garnered international acclaim since its formation in 1871 and from which Music City earned its moniker; and

WHEREAS, notable scholars of the highly ranked Fisk University include W.E.B. Du Bois, Booker T. Washington, Ida B. Wells, and Congressman John Lewis; and

WHEREAS, Fisk University is located in the North Nashville community and currently benefits from the astute leadership of President Dr. Agenia Walker Clark, who is proud to continue the school's mission to produce graduates from different backgrounds with the integrity and intellect to contribute substantially to society; and

WHEREAS, Fisk University has continued its tradition as an institution of access, and its lasting impact on Nashville is a testament to its resilience, resistance, and excellence; and

WHEREAS, for 160 years, Fisk University has shone as a beacon of distinction in both academic performance and the collegiate experience, and the school should be recognized on this momentous occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Fisk University on 160 years of excellence in higher education and join with its administration, faculty, staff, students, and alumni as they celebrate the institution's 160th anniversary.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.